

Products at Their Best at CES

Cutting-edge technology does not ensure success. It takes three T's—technology, timing and thoughtfulness—to make a winning product. Here are six such products that won accolades at Consumer Electronics Show (CES) 2013

EFY BUREAU



Carrier-independent, low-power emergency phone

SpareOne is an emergency communication device that ensures you remain connected even in the worst situations. It works with a single AA-size battery and has 15 years of battery life when stored unused, or 10 hours of talk time when in use. It has a durable torch light, dedicated emergency number calling buttons, and a weather-proof package.

Debuted at CES, SpareOnePlus includes a location-based service to identify the exact location of the cell ID—accessible through a free smart-phone app—as well as audible numeric feedback which reads dialled numbers and incoming calls aloud. The phone can be ordered from their website and costs less than \$100.

Inside: Both models are available in two GSM frequencies to enable use across the world: 850/1900 MHz and 900/1800 MHz. SpareOne is SIM unlocked, so it can accept SIM cards of any GSM operator. Micro-SIM adaptors are also available to insert iOS SIM cards. So you can insert practically any SIM with credit and start making calls at local rates. Other benefits include a light-emitting diode torch, low power consumption, and a talk-through, re-sealable waterproof bag with humidity-proof seal.

Doctor in your pocket

Scanadu, a company based at the NASA-Ames Research Center, has developed a home diagnostic tool called SCOUT to study the vital signs that reflect your health condition. Just hold SCOUT to the temple. In less than ten seconds it reads more than five vital signs and transmits the information to a mobile application, which instantly calculates the pulse transit time, heart rate, electrical heart activity, temperature, heart rate variability and blood oxygenation. This information can be shared with a doctor, or stored and studied over time to figure out how healthy you are.

At CES 2013, Scanadu also unveiled ScanaFlo that does urine-based tests, and ScanaFlu that detects upper respiratory tract infections using a saliva sample. These are also integrated with a mobile app. All three devices will be launched later this year, at a price less than \$150.

Inside: All three devices use body sensors, molecular diagnostics, imaging and sound analysis, data analytics and a suite of algorithms to study and offer a comprehensive, real-time picture of your health data. They fit the description of a 'tricorder.' The software platform is extensible and can be opened up to input from other tracking and monitoring devices.



More power from your car's cigarette lighter

The XC180 is claimed to be the world's smallest cup inverter that can convert 12V DC power into 180W AC. It plugs into your vehicle's cigarette lighter, fits securely in a cup holder, and outputs enough power for four devices—a 120V AC outlet for laptops, DVD players, etc and three USB ports that can charge electronic devices including iPad. Its 5V DC, 2.1A USB ports are capable of charging four times faster than standard USB.

Inside: The 12V modified sinewave cup inverter features a 7.9x7.9cm² (3.1x3.1-inch²) footprint and a noiseless technology that uses an ultra-silent thermal fan. It has three USB ports and an AC outlet. It takes 10-15.5V input and outputs 110-120V in 60MHz frequency range. It is protected against overload and short circuit, and comes with cigarette lighter and battery clip cables.

